



eventara

PRODUCT & ENGINEERING DUE DILIGENCE

Brutally Honest Product Audit

An investor-grade teardown of the Eventara two-sided event marketplace - strategy, UX, UI, engineering, security, and market readiness.

Subject: Eventara - B2B event marketplace for Udaipur (Corporate & Institutional, Phase 1)

Artifact reviewed: Static multi-page prototype (13 pages) · v2.1 · deployed on Vercel

Reviewer lens: Sr. PM · UX Researcher · Product Designer · Eng Manager · Founder (marketplace)

Review type: Pre-scale due diligence · **Date:** 22 July 2026

Disclosure: This review is deliberately critical. Praise is reserved for what is genuinely strong.

1. Executive Summary

Eventara is one of the most *polished front-end prototypes* I have reviewed at this stage - and, simultaneously, one of the least *real products*. Those two statements are both true, and the gap between them is the entire story of this audit.

What it actually is. Eventara is a static, client-side-only website: 13 hand-written HTML pages sharing one CSS design system and a few vanilla-JS modules. There is **no backend, no database, no server, and no real transactions**. Every marketplace primitive the product promises - accounts, sessions, search, matching, quotes, escrow payments, GST invoices, bookings, payouts, disputes, notifications, reviews - is **simulated in HTML and localStorage**. Buttons that would hit a server in production show a toast instead. This is an excellent *investor demo and design reference*. It is not, in any meaningful engineering sense, a marketplace yet.

What is genuinely strong. The product *thinking* is well above average. The strategic wedge - "your payment is held safely until your event is delivered" (escrow) targeted at *corporate and institutional* buyers in a single city - is a sharp, defensible insight. Indian B2B event booking is plagued by advance-payment fraud and opaque pricing; a trust layer is a real wedge. The customer journey (structured brief -> matched suppliers -> side-by-side quote comparison -> escrow booking -> GST invoice) is coherent and mirrors how procurement actually thinks. The visual craft - typography, spacing, the restrained Airbnb-influenced design system, the two dashboards, the account dropdown - is clean and consistent. The team clearly sweats details (measured contrast ratios, 44px touch targets, cache-busting discipline).

Where it will fail due diligence. Five things, in order of severity:

1. **Zero real infrastructure.** A marketplace's value *is* its transaction, trust, and matching engine. None exist. This is 100% of the hard part still to be built.
2. **Cold-start / liquidity.** ~7 named suppliers, one fully built (Paandora Grand), one city, one narrow vertical. No demand, no supply, no proof either side shows up. The chicken-and-egg problem is unaddressed.
3. **Security is a facade.** Auth is `localStorage` + a client-side redirect guard, trivially bypassed from devtools; demo credentials sit in page source. Acceptable for a demo, disqualifying for anything touching money.
4. **No reviews, no real trust signals.** "Verified," "4.6★," "GSTIN ✓" are hard-coded strings. Reviews are the oxygen of marketplaces and are entirely absent.
5. **Architecture won't scale.** Copy-pasted navbars/footers across 13 files, manual per-file cache-busting (already a recurring source of friction), no framework, no tests, no CMS for supply. Multi-city is not reachable from here without a rebuild.

Bottom line. As a *Phase-0 design and narrative artifact* to raise a pre-seed round or run 5-10 concierge pilots, this is strong - top-decile prototype craft. As a *product ready to onboard suppliers and take money*, it is roughly 10-15% complete, and the remaining 85% is the genuinely difficult 85%. Invest in the *team and the wedge*, not the codebase.

2-9. Scorecard

SCORED AS A PRE-SCALE MARKETPLACE ASPIRING TO COMPETE WITH BEST-IN-CLASS PLATFORMS - NOT GRADED ON A PROTOTYPE CURVE.

OVERALL PRODUCT 4.3 _{/10}	UX (EXPERIENCE) 7.0 _{/10}
UI (INTERFACE) 7.5 _{/10}	PRODUCT STRATEGY 5.5 _{/10}
ENGINEERING QUALITY 3.5 _{/10}	MARKETPLACE READINESS 2.5 _{/10}
MOBILE EXPERIENCE 6.5 _{/10}	SECURITY 2.0 _{/10}

Dimension	Score	One-line rationale
Overall Product	4.3	Exceptional prototype craft; near-zero production substance. Averages down hard on infra/security/liquidity.
UX	7.0	Coherent, well-sequenced journeys and strong information architecture; friction in search, empty states, and "dead" actions.
UI	7.5	Disciplined design system, consistent components, good typography. A few naming/contrast/glass inconsistencies.
Product Strategy	5.5	Sharp niche + trust wedge, but thin moat, unproven demand, small initial TAM, weak monetization proof.
Engineering Quality	3.5	Clean for vanilla, but no backend/framework/tests, duplicated markup, manual cache-busting - unscalable.
Marketplace Readiness	2.5	One real supplier, mock everything, no reviews, no real payments/matching. Pre-liquidity.
Mobile Experience	6.5	Recently hardened (calendar scroll, date field, dropdown), but a 320px navbar clip and native-control quirks remain.
Security	2.0	Client-side auth bypassable in seconds; hard-coded creds in source; no server-side validation or authz.

How to read these. A 7.5 on UI and a 2.0 on Security are not contradictory - they reflect that Eventara has invested almost entirely in the *presentation layer* and almost not at all in the *system layer*. That imbalance is the central finding.

10. Top 20 Critical Issues (ranked by severity)

EACH: WHY IT'S A PROBLEM · BUSINESS/USER IMPACT · SEVERITY · FIX · HOW LEADERS SOLVE IT.

#	Issue	Severity	Why it matters, impact & the fix (with a benchmark)
1	No backend / no real transactions	CRITICAL	Everything is mocked. A marketplace is its transaction engine; none exists. Impact: cannot onboard a real supplier, take a real booking, or hold a real rupee. Fix: build a minimal backend (Postgres + an API + a payments/escrow provider) before <i>any</i> other feature. Benchmark: Airbnb/Booking are, at core, a booking+payments ledger with a UI on top - the UI is the easy 20%.
2	Client-side auth is trivially bypassable	CRITICAL	<code>Auth.requireRole()</code> is a render-time redirect reading <code>localStorage</code> . Setting <code>localStorage['eventara_session']={role:'supplier'}</code> in devtools grants the supplier portal. Impact: no real access control; any "protected" data would be exposed. Fix: server-issued, httpOnly, signed session cookies; server-side authorization on every request. Benchmark: every serious platform verifies sessions server-side; the client guard is only cosmetic.
3	Marketplace liquidity / cold-start unaddressed	CRITICAL	~7 suppliers, 1 city, 1 vertical, no demand engine. Impact: empty search results kill trust; no reason for either side to show up. Fix: pick ONE dense niche (e.g., 40 Udaipur corporate venues), manually onboard supply first, run concierge demand. Benchmark: Airbnb hand-onboarded NYC hosts and shot their photos; Urban Company seeded supply city-by-city before opening demand.
4	No reviews or ratings system	CRITICAL	"4.6★ (214)" is a hard-coded string; there is no way to submit, moderate, or display real reviews. Impact: zero social proof - the #1 driver of marketplace conversion. Fix: post-event verified reviews tied to completed bookings. Benchmark: Booking.com's "only guests who stayed can review" is the gold standard for review integrity.
5	Search does not actually search	CRITICAL	The hero search and filters route to a static <code>search.html</code> with a fixed list; no query, filter, availability, or ranking logic. Impact: the core discovery loop is non-functional. Fix: real search over a supplier index (filters: capacity, date availability, budget, event type, amenities) with relevance ranking. Benchmark: Airbnb/VenueLook lead with availability-aware, filterable, map-optional search.
6	Trust badges are decorative, not verified	CRITICAL	"Verified · GSTIN ✓ FSSAI ✓ · Payment Protected" are static labels with no verification pipeline behind them. Impact: if surfaced to real users this is <i>misleading</i> and a legal/brand risk. Fix: a real KYC/verification workflow (GSTIN API, document review, a verified state machine). Benchmark: Urban Company's background-checked "verified professional" is an operational process, not a badge.
7	Escrow / "payment protected" is fictional	CRITICAL	The escrow timeline, deposit-held, and payout logic are UI illustrations. Impact: the <i>entire value proposition</i> ("money safe till delivery") does not exist. Fix: integrate a real escrow/nodal-account flow (RBI-compliant PA/PG, e.g., Razorpay Route/Cashfree) with a ledger. Benchmark: this is regulated in India - it is a build + compliance project, not a screen.

8	No data persistence of any kind	CRITICAL	Form submissions (brief, profile, settings, disputes, help) go nowhere; refresh loses everything except the localStorage session. Impact: nothing a user does is real or recoverable. Fix: persist to a database via an API. Benchmark: table stakes everywhere.
9	Hard-coded credentials & single hard-coded business	HIGH	Demo logins live in <code>signin.html</code> source; the supplier portal is hard-wired to "Paandora Grand." Impact: not multi-tenant; credentials in a public repo. Fix: real user records; dynamic tenant context from the session. Benchmark: any SaaS is multi-tenant from day one.
10	Duplicated markup across 13 pages	HIGH	Navbar, footer, mobile menu, and head are copy-pasted into every file; one nav change means 13 edits. Impact: guaranteed drift, slow iteration, bugs. Fix: components/partials (a framework, or at minimum server includes / a static-site generator). Benchmark: every modern stack componentizes chrome.
11	Manual cache-busting (? v=N) across all files	HIGH	Asset versions are bumped by hand in 13 files on every CSS/JS change - already a repeated pain point and a stale-asset risk. Impact: users see broken/half-updated UI; error-prone releases. Fix: content-hashed filenames via a build step. Benchmark: standard bundler output (Vite/webpack) hashes automatically.
12	No availability / calendar sync between supply & demand	HIGH	The supplier calendar and any customer date selection are unconnected; double-booking is possible in concept. Impact: the core scheduling promise ("never double-book") is unbacked. Fix: a single availability service that search, quotes, and the calendar all read/write. Benchmark: Booking/Airbnb calendars are the source of truth for pricing and inventory.
13	Action buttons are "dead" (toast-only)	HIGH	Build Quote, Respond, Upload Evidence, Save Settings, Pay Balance, etc. only fire a toast. Impact: reviewers/pilots quickly hit the "nothing actually happens" wall; erodes credibility. Fix: wire the top 5 flows end-to-end before demos to real customers. Benchmark: n/a - this is a demo tell.
14	No notifications backbone	HIGH	The bell is a static list; no email/SMS/WhatsApp/push delivery, no persistence, no read-state across sessions. Impact: quote SLAs ("reply in 48h"), booking confirmations, and payout alerts - all central to the model - cannot fire. Fix: a notification service (transactional email + WhatsApp Business API is essential in India). Benchmark: Urban Company/Booking run heavily on WhatsApp + SMS in India.
15	Thin differentiation / weak moat	HIGH	VenueLook, Weddingz, Sulekha, and Justdial already occupy venue discovery. Escrow-for-B2B is a real angle but copyable. Impact: without a data or network moat, incumbents can add "protected payments." Fix: build proprietary supply relationships + a verified-quality data asset (real reviews, delivery track records). Benchmark: Airbnb's moat is host+guest network density and review corpus, not features.
16	Small initial TAM, long B2B sales cycle	HIGH	Corporate/institutional events in one tier-2 city is a smart wedge but a small starting pond with slow procurement cycles. Impact: slow GMV ramp; hard to show hockey-stick to investors. Fix: define the

expansion path (adjacent cities OR adjacent verticals) explicitly with unit economics. Benchmark: Booking started with Dutch hotels then templated expansion.

17	No analytics / instrumentation	HIGH	No event tracking, funnels, or error monitoring anywhere. Impact: you will scale blind - cannot see where the funnel leaks or what converts. Fix: add product analytics (e.g., PostHog/GA4) + error tracking (Sentry) before pilots. Benchmark: every data-driven marketplace instruments the funnel obsessively.
18	Accessibility gaps beneath a good baseline	MEDIUM	Good ARIA on the new dropdown, but color-as-only-signal on statuses, native date-input quirks, unlabeled icon-only controls in places, and no audited keyboard path through full flows. Impact: excludes users; risk under accessibility norms. Fix: an axe/Lighthouse pass + manual SR test on the 5 core flows. Benchmark: Airbnb maintains a public a11y program.
19	320px navbar clip & native-control inconsistency	MEDIUM	Shared navbar content overflows ~17px at 320px (hamburger clipped; masked by <code>overflow-x:hidden</code>); native <code><select></code> / <code><input type=date></code> render inconsistently across mobile browsers. Impact: small-device polish gaps on the exact segment (mobile) that dominates Indian traffic. Fix: fluid navbar down to 320; consider custom select/date components. Benchmark: leaders ship custom pickers for cross-browser consistency.
20	Public repo + third-party image hotlinking	MEDIUM	Supplier photos are hotlinked from third-party hotel/booking sites; the repo is public. Impact: broken images when hosts change URLs, hotlink blocking, and potential rights issues; anything committed is scraped. Fix: host owned/licensed media in your own storage/CDN; keep secrets and business data out of a public repo. Benchmark: all platforms host first-party, rights-cleared media.

11. Top 20 High-Impact Improvements

HIGHEST ROI CHANGES ASSUMING A BACKEND IS BEING BUILT IN PARALLEL. ORDERED BY LEVERAGE.

1. **Ship a real, filterable, availability-aware search** as the product's spine - everything else hangs off discovery.
2. **Verified post-event reviews** tied to completed bookings; surface rating + count + recent quotes everywhere a supplier appears.
3. **Wire the 5 golden flows end-to-end** (brief -> quote -> accept -> pay deposit -> invoice) before any customer demo.
4. **Real escrow via a regulated PA/PG** (Razorpay Route / Cashfree Easy Split) with a visible, truthful money-status timeline.
5. **WhatsApp + email notification service** for enquiry SLAs, quotes, confirmations, and payouts - WhatsApp is non-negotiable in India.
6. **Componentize the chrome** (nav/footer/head) and add a build step with hashed assets - removes an entire class of release bugs.
7. **Instrument the funnel** (search -> brief -> quote view -> booking) and add Sentry; make decisions on data, not vibes.
8. **Supplier onboarding wizard** with real KYC (GSTIN validation, docs, bank/UPI) and a "profile completeness" score that gates going live.
9. **A genuine matching engine** (event type × budget × capacity × availability × location) replacing "3 matched" placeholders.
10. **Quote builder that produces a structured, comparable quote object** - the compare page must diff real line items, not static cells.
11. **Redesign empty states** as guidance (what to do next), not blank "no data" - especially first-run dashboards.
12. **Persist notifications & read-state server-side** so the bell is trustworthy across devices.
13. **Availability as a single source of truth** shared by search, quotes, calendar, and booking to prevent double-booking.
14. **Add pricing transparency**: show typical price bands, what's included/excluded, and cancellation terms upfront on every listing.
15. **Dispute workflow with real states, evidence upload to storage, and SLA timers** - this is a trust differentiator if it actually works.
16. **First-party, rights-cleared media pipeline** (upload, crop, CDN) replacing hotlinked images.
17. **Role-correct settings for both sides** already exists in shell - back it with real preference persistence and verification (email/phone OTP).
18. **Accessibility hardening pass** (status text not just color, labels on icon buttons, keyboard audit of core flows).
19. **Mobile: custom select/date components** + fix the 320px navbar for full-range consistency.
20. **A lightweight admin/ops console with real data** (the `ops.html` shell is a good start) for verification, dispute mediation, and payouts.
21. **SEO + content surface** (indexable venue pages, city/venue landing pages) - organic discovery is the cheapest demand channel for venue marketplaces.

12. Features to Remove or Simplify

Feature	Verdict	Why
AI chatbot (Gemini + 50-intent offline engine)	Defer / simplify	Impressive engineering, but it is surface area and cost with little value pre-liquidity. A well-structured FAQ + WhatsApp-to-human covers 90% of early needs. Keep the offline FAQ bot; shelve the LLM endpoint until volume justifies it.
Three calendar views (Month/Week/Day)	Simplify	Week/Day are thin and add maintenance. Ship Month + an agenda list; add Week/Day only when suppliers ask.
Separate FAQ and Help Centre pages	Merge	Two support surfaces fragment the mental model. Merge into one "Help" with search + contact; the split adds IA cost for no gain.
Analytics tab shell / decorative pipeline & performance widgets	Cut until real	Fake charts erode credibility in a demo. Remove until backed by real data.
Ops console (ops.html) exposed in prototype	Hide	Internal tooling shouldn't ship in the public artifact; it widens the security/attack surface and confuses reviewers.
Glassmorphic sign-in card density	Keep, tune	Looks premium and is well-executed; just keep contrast AA-safe (already measured) and avoid over-blurring on low-end Android.

Principle: pre-liquidity, every feature you can defer is runway saved and attack surface removed. Concentrate all energy on *supply onboarding + one working transaction*.

13. Features to Build Next & 14-16 Roadmap

Missing features, prioritized

Priority	Feature	Note
MUST	Backend + DB + API	Prerequisite for literally everything below.
MUST	Server-side auth & authorization	httpOnly sessions, OTP login, RBAC enforced on the server.
MUST	Real search + matching + availability	The discovery spine.
MUST	Payments + escrow (regulated PA/PG)	The value proposition made real.
MUST	Reviews & ratings (verified)	Trust and conversion.
MUST	Supplier KYC/verification pipeline	Makes "verified" honest.
MUST	Notifications (WhatsApp/email/SMS)	SLA + confirmations + payouts.
SHOULD	Structured quote builder + real compare	Line-item diffs, PDF export.
SHOULD	Analytics + error monitoring	See the funnel; catch failures.
SHOULD	Media upload + CDN	First-party imagery.
SHOULD	In-app messaging (masked) buyer↔supplier	Keep comms + audit trail on-platform.
NICE	Saved searches / shortlists with alerts	Retention loop.
NICE	Contracts / e-sign, calendar (ICS) export	Procurement-grade polish.
FUTURE	Dynamic pricing, demand forecasting, multi-city ops, supplier financing, API/partner integrations	Post-liquidity scale plays.

14. Quick Wins (1-2 weeks)

- Add product analytics + Sentry (half a day, huge ongoing leverage).
- Componentize nav/footer via a static-site generator or includes; introduce hashed assets - kills the manual ? v=N chore permanently.
- Fix the 320px navbar; replace native selects/date with consistent components on the hero.
- Redesign the top 3 empty states into guided next-steps.
- Merge FAQ + Help; hide ops.html from the public build.
- Replace hotlinked images with self-hosted copies (removes a live-breakage risk).

15. Medium-Term (1-3 months)

- Stand up backend + DB; migrate auth to server sessions with OTP; make one full booking real end-to-end for a single pilot venue.
- Ship real search/matching/availability over 30-50 hand-onboarded Udaipur suppliers.
- Integrate payments + a first, simple escrow/split flow; issue a real GST invoice.
- Launch verified reviews + WhatsApp notifications.

- Instrument the funnel and run 10 concierge-supported bookings; measure take-rate, quote-to-book, and NPS.

16. Long-Term (6-18 months)

- Prove single-city unit economics (CAC per side, take rate, repeat rate, contribution margin) before any geographic expansion.
- Templatize city launch (supply playbook, ops console, local ops hire) -> expand to 2-3 comparable cities.
- Deepen the moat: proprietary delivery track-record data, quality scoring, supplier financing/working-capital, exclusive supply.
- Consider a controlled move into the adjacent (and larger) wedding/social vertical *only* once B2B liquidity is self-sustaining.

17. Launch Readiness Assessment

Stage	Ready?	What must be true first
Investor demo / design reference	YES - today	Already strong. Use it to sell the vision and raise, not to take money.
Concierge pilot (5-10 bookings, humans in the loop)	Not yet (~4-6 wks)	Needs: real data persistence, one working payment, honest (not simulated) trust claims, and a manual ops process behind the UI. Doable fast if scoped to one venue.
Beta launch (self-serve, limited)	No (~3-4 months)	Needs: server auth, real search/matching/availability, escrow, reviews, notifications, KYC, analytics, and the security fixes in §10.
Commercial launch (one city)	No (~6-9 months)	Needs: proven liquidity in Udaipur, dispute ops that work, SLAs met, positive contribution margin on a cohort, security & compliance audit passed.
Multi-city / pan-India	No (~12-18 months+)	Needs: a repeatable city-launch playbook, componentized/scalable architecture, ops tooling, and unit economics that survive expansion.

Hard gate: do not put the words "Payment Protected," "Verified," or "Escrow" in front of a paying customer until those systems are real and compliant. Today they are UI copy; shipping them as fact is a trust and legal liability.

Competitive Benchmarking & 18. Final Verdict

Where Eventara stands vs. the field

Platform	Eventara is STRONGER on...	Eventara is WEAKER on...
VenueLook / Weddingz / Sulekha (India venue discovery)	Cleaner UX, escrow/trust narrative, B2B focus, GST-native invoicing framing	Real supply density, reviews, bookings, brand, traffic - they are live businesses; Eventara is a prototype
Urban Company	Nothing yet (aspirational UI parity only)	Verified supply operations, ratings, payments, logistics, scale - all real there
Airbnb / Booking.com	Nothing yet; narrower, clearer B2B niche is the only edge	Everything operational: inventory, availability, payments, reviews, trust, search
WeddingWire / Eventbrite	Escrow-for-B2B angle; procurement-shaped flow	Two-sided liquidity, supplier tooling maturity, review corpus

Differentiation opportunity (real): "The trusted, GST-clean, payment-protected way for companies and institutions to book events" is a defensible position *if* the escrow and verification are genuinely delivered and the delivery track-record data becomes proprietary. The niche (B2B, tier-2 first, corporate/institutional) is under-served by wedding-obsessed incumbents. That is the wedge worth pursuing.

18. Final Verdict - Would I invest in, or launch, this today?

Launch as a product taking real money: No. It is a front-end shell over an empty stage. Roughly 85% of the hard work - the transaction, trust, matching, and payments systems - does not exist, and the security model would not survive first contact with a motivated user.

Invest in the team and the wedge: Qualified yes, at pre-seed. What this prototype proves is *taste, product sense, and a sharp market insight* - escrow-backed, GST-clean, corporate/institutional event booking in an under-served tier-2 market. Those are the things that are hard to teach; infrastructure is the thing money and time can buy. I would fund a small round contingent on: (1) a credible technical plan to build the backend/payments/escrow, (2) a concierge pilot that produces 10 *real* bookings with real money and measured take-rate within 90 days, and (3) hard evidence that supply and demand both show up in one dense niche.

The one-sentence summary: Eventara today is a beautiful menu in a restaurant with no kitchen - the menu is good enough to make me want to eat here, so now go build the kitchen, and don't tell diners the food is ready until it is.